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Is your Company a Team or a Family?

**Vikas Surani**

Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA



June 1, 2025

Hello Curious Minds,

Imagine this: In a family, you're loved unconditionally. In a team, you're valued for what you bring to the game. Both sound good — but which one truly fits the workplace?

That's the question. And the answer? Depends on who (and where) you ask.

**Around the world, the workplace metaphor varies:**

Japan nurtures the "company as family" philosophy — lifelong employment, deep loyalty.



The U.S. leans hard into the "team" model — high performance, fast pivots.



Sweden blends trust and autonomy with collective accountability.



India often calls itself a work family — yet performance reviews and power distance hint otherwise.



Mexico? A company should be a high-performing team

👉 **My view: A company should be a high-performing team.**

Why? Because teams are built on clarity — of roles, goals, and accountability. They train together, grow together, and yes — sometimes, part ways respectfully. But they do it all in service of a shared mission.

💡 The best teams also nurture each other. They check in when someone's off their game. They celebrate success and bounce back from failure — together. They build belonging *with boundaries*.

So maybe the sweet spot isn't choosing one metaphor over the other... It's building **teams with heart** ❤️ — where care meets clarity, and belonging meets boldness.

👁️ What about you? Does your workplace feel more like a family, a team — or something else entirely?

👉 Drop your thoughts in the comments. Let's keep *Being Curious*.

By **Vikas Surani** 📧 Sent to 2,373+ subscribers | [Join or share the newsletter →](#)

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Senthil Kumar · 1st
CTO @ PixelTree | Leading Tech Strategy with Meta Expertise

6mo ...

"We often hear 'we're a family' or 'we're a team.' But practically speaking, what's one specific action your company takes that truly makes you feel like you belong to either a family or a high-performing team?"

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Senthil Kumar · 1st
CTO @ PixelTree | Leading Tech Strategy with Meta Experti...

6mo ...

Spot on, Vikas! That's a brilliant way to put it – 'clarity and care makes all the difference.' Thanks for sharing your perspective!"

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Maqbulhusen Malaiwala ✓ · 1st
Senior Consultant Fusion Finance | Accounting & Finance Expert

6mo ...

Company is just Company and it can't be considered as Family.

You are always replaceable where as A member in Family can't be replaced.

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**Vikas Surani**  Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

6mo ...

Maqbulhusen Malaiwala Exactly — family is irreplaceable, but a company thrives when its team feels connected and purposeful.

**Monodeep Saha**  · 2nd
Consultant

Like · Reply · 179 impressions

Team model with high performance and role clarity but with empathy. The blend gives more success...

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**Vikas Surani**  Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

6mo ...

Monodeep Saha Totally agree — performance + empathy is a winning combo. That balance drives both results and trust.

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Saumendra Rathod  · 1st
Oracle Cloud Project/programme Management

6mo ...

Company is a company and family is a family. Let us put hand on a heart and ask ourselves “Which company does not call itself a family?”.

Team most of the times is an overdose of ordinariness used to downplay superiority of talent over mediocrity. If teams were inc ...more

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**Vikas Surani**  Author
Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

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Saumendra Rathod no but that's what now a days companies do so

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